

Improve your worst piece

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

When no immediate tactic demands action, identify the piece contributing least to the position. Look for a route to a useful square and check whether you have time to make it. This turns vague maneuvering into a specific improvement.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A bishop trapped behind its own central pawns may need a pawn break rather than another bishop move. A knight on the rim may need two moves to reach a stable central square. Diagnose the cause of inactivity first.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

How do you choose between two possible improving moves?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Compare the task each piece gains, the time required, and the opponent's best response. Favor improvements that also defend a weakness or prepare a useful pawn break.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Give an inactive piece a job and a safe route to it.